

Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in case management, client communication and procedural document work at BCLP, Citizens Advice and Q-Legal. Experienced in managing matters from instruction through to submission, maintaining confidential case files, meeting procedural deadlines and advising vulnerable clients on complex legal and regulatory requirements. Particular interest in work where legal process has a direct effect on the lives of the people it concerns.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- International arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module (data privacy and democracy) — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law, Company Law

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial scholarship toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Acts as primary point of contact for clients across welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets procedural deadlines
- Assesses eligibility for Universal Credit, Housing Benefit and related support against statutory and regulatory criteria; researches complex points and identifies evidential gaps
- Translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals, including those with limited capacity to engage with formal processes

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines across an active investment arbitration matter
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and liaised with an external translator to ensure on-time delivery
- Reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; amended sections of the memorial
- Liaised directly with the client on required documents; received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Prepared electronic hearing bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials for contested hearings
- Maintained matter records via iManage; assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking across several matters with competing timescales
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across multiple active files
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes; prepared client notes

Q-Legal · Remote

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations; identified compliance risks and recommended practical mitigations
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the matter deadline; translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries; communicated amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; concise report writing; client interviewing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; electronic bundling; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: Case-file organisation and maintenance; deadline tracking; evidence review; hearing bundle preparation; procedural histories; correspondence drafting; document scheduling